

Agentic Coding

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Chapter 1

Introduction

Motivation

- There's a lot of hype around vibe coding at the moment

“No more humans coding in 5 years.”

Emad Mostaque

“AI will write most of the code soon and perform better than top coders.”

Mark Zuckerberg

“It's our job to create computing technology such that nobody has to program.”

Jensen Huang

Motivation (2)

- We have a slightly different opinion
- This is not the first hype we have seen



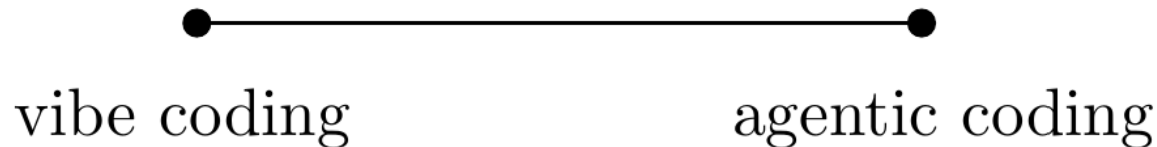
- We will try to bring some substance to this discussion

Things are Definitely Changing

- In the foreseeable future, AI will not replace developers
 - A developer using AI will replace one who doesn't
 - and developers (already) work differently
- Currently, AI boosts the skills of experienced experts
- It will not save you if you have no clue what you're doing

Basic Terminology

- Coding with AI covers a whole spectrum
 - Vibe coding: prompt and hope for the best
 - Agentic coding: a systematic approach that still utilizes software development principles



Vibe Coding

- Vibe coding typically looks like the following:
 - Write a prompt, e.g. “Build an app that does X.”
 - LLM generates some code
 - User tries it out, doesn't quite work
 - User writes another prompt requesting some changes
 - LLM changes code
 - Wash, rinse, repeat

Agentic Coding

- This is not about writing simple prompts
- Gives an LLM specific software development tasks in a systematic way, such as:
 - Formulate goal, e.g., in form of a specification
 - Devise a plan, break up general task into subtasks
 - Generate code
 - Validate code, e.g., by running tests
 - If necessary, revise implementation (or even planning)

Vibe-Coding vs. Agentic Coding

- That doesn't necessarily mean that vibe coding is bad and agentic coding is good
- Vibe coding:
 - makes sense for rapid prototyping
 - is for quickly trying out things
- Agentic coding
 - is a thorough process
 - creates reliable code

What Can Go Wrong?

- AI gets stuck in infinite loops
- Deliver incorrect solutions confidently
- Cheat: optimize for validation such as benchmarks
- Implements what you said, not what you meant
 - General problem, existed before AI

Summary

- Then: translate ideas into code (programming)
- Now: translate ideas into prompts (vibe-coding)
- Then: (systematically) applying principles and methods to create reliable software (software engineering)
- Now: give an AI (software-engineering) goals and constraints to create software (agentic coding)
- Important question: how much of the software-engineering process can be delegated?









